

Participant information and consent

Stage 2 workshop

Study: AI-Supported Deliberation Experiment (Swiss AI Futures)	Ethics project: 26 ETHICS-116
Research team: Maud Reveilhac (Principal Investigator), Maud.Reveilhac@lut.fi; Joshua C. Yang (Experiment Lead), ETH Zurich – joyang@ethz.ch; Aurelia Tamò-Larrieux. Funded by TA-SWISS.	
Workshops: Zurich – 11 August 2026, 17:30–19:30, ETH room to be confirmed. Lausanne – 12 August 2026, two-hour time and accessible venue to be confirmed.	

Your workshop group - choose one

☐ Zürich – English
 ☐ Zürich – German

☐ Lausanne – French
 ☐ Lausanne – English

You are invited to a voluntary citizen workshop about possible AI futures in education and work. We compare AI-supported spoken discussion with trained human moderation and ask how fairly each process and final group text represents the discussion.

What participation involves

- You may take part if you are 18 or older, live in Switzerland, can attend, complete the approximately 30-minute online preparation, and can participate comfortably in German or English in Zurich, or French or English in Lausanne.
- The research-team application is used for preparation. At the approximately two-hour workshop, a small group discusses education first and work/labour second, producing 2–3 recommendations, reasons, and any remaining disagreement or uncertainty. You may correct, reject, or revise the group text.
- After each discussion you complete a short coded Qualtrics survey; crossover participants also complete a final comparison. Surveys do not ask for your name or email. You may skip any question.

Speech, AI and your pathway

- Only AI-supported tables use a researcher-controlled microphone. Speech is sent live to OpenAI Whisper for transcription. No audio file is created or retained. OpenAI also processes coded transcript text and limited group context to draft a summary; a facilitator checks every draft and the group may revise it.
- The OpenAI project is to process study content in Europe without provider retention or model training. The AI does not decide for the group, rank people, or privately score participants.
- If you do not want OpenAI to process your speech, tell the study team before signing. A human-only pathway may be available and will be explained and documented separately. At human-moderated tables there is no microphone, audio capture, automated transcription, or OpenAI processing. Compensation and withdrawal rights are unchanged; human-only data do not enter the primary crossover comparison.

Data and privacy

- Registration/contact data, research data, consent records, and payment details are kept separately. Research records use a random study code. Please avoid names, employers, or other unnecessary identifying details in discussion. Bank details, if used, are collected in a separate administrative process.
- ETH Zurich controls the data. Authorised, confidentiality-bound researchers may access coded data. Decision Lab may manage recruitment/payment but receives no linked transcript. Independent raters may see de-identified group texts or limited AI-transcript extracts. TA-SWISS receives no individual data.
- The temporary application copy is deleted within 48 hours after verified export; the Qualtrics working copy within 30 days. Coded transcripts, moderator records, group interaction data and derived research data may be kept on restricted ETH storage for up to 10 years; consent records for 5 years. Full transcripts are not published, but anonymised or paraphrased quotations may be used. Context can leave a small residual risk of identification.

Rights, risks and payment

- Participation is voluntary. You may pause, step out, skip survey questions, or withdraw without a reason. Before anonymisation or irreversible aggregation, you may ask the principal investigator to delete data still linkable to you where feasible; fully anonymous data cannot later be isolated. Declining Stage 2 does not affect authorised Stage 1 participation.
- Risks are minimal but include discomfort about contested issues, transcription/AI errors, loss of nuance, and others hearing what you say. The group is asked to respect privacy, but confidentiality by other participants cannot be guaranteed. A support person and quiet space are available. No personal benefit is guaranteed. Study-related harm is covered by ETH liability policy 30/4.078.362.
- You receive CHF 60 after completing both the approximately 30-minute preparation and approximately two-hour workshop. There is no partial payment if you do not attend or withdraw before both are complete. Skipping survey questions does not affect payment. If the team ends the workshop early, attendance until release counts. Choose bank transfer or an equal-value voucher; payment data stay outside research data.

Questions/data: joyang@ethz.ch ETH data protection: ds@ethz.ch Complaints: ethics@sl.ethz.ch, +41 44 632 85 72

Your consent

By signing below, I confirm: I have read and understood this page, had the opportunity to ask questions, meet the eligibility criteria, and take part voluntarily. I consent to transient live capture of speech at the AI-supported table, OpenAI Whisper transcription, and a text-model draft summary. No audio file is kept. I consent to restricted retention and research use of the resulting coded transcript for up to 10 years. I understand that the facilitator and group can revise outputs, and I understand the risks, withdrawal and deletion limits. I will participate in one AI-supported and one human-moderated discussion.

Participant name

Place / date

Participant signature